ACAMIS TECHNOLOGY CONFERENCE · OCTOBER 18, 2026

A case study from the International School of Beijing

From Lab *to Classroom*

Running an AI Student Program Inside a School

THE NEXT 60 MINUTES

From what students built in five days *to what you can run at your school.*

1

The case

15 minutes

2

Why it worked

10 minutes

3

Build one, live

30 minutes

4

Take it back

5 minutes

We trained at ISB, Caltech, Harvard, Brown, and Tsinghua, then did *the jobs AI is now automating.*



Jing Jing Yang

WAB AND ISB ALUM · ISB CLASS OF 2019

Ran the AI Founders Program at ISB, summer 2026
Worked in international growth at Kimi, a leading Chinese AI lab

STUDIED INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校 · BROWN · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED Deloitte. · CICC 中金公司 · KIMI



Phillip An

FORBES 30 UNDER 30

Co-founder and CEO of Skylarq AI
Co-founder and ex-COO of Homebase, backed by Y Combinator

STUDIED Caltech · HARVARD · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED Goldman Sachs · McKinsey&Company · LinkedIn

THE QUESTION BEHIND THIS SESSION

When AI can do all of these in seconds, what must our students *still learn to do?*

WHERE THIS STARTED · ISB PTA PARENT COFFEE, OCTOBER 14, 2026

Parents asked us one practical question: *which skills will outlast the tools?*

WHAT PARENTS ASKED

Which skills last as the tools change?

Will AI do the thinking for my child?

What should my child practice now?

WHAT THIS SESSION SHOWS

Three skills that outlast any tool

A program where students do the thinking

Real products, built in five days

PART 1

In five days, ISB students built and launched *working products with AI.*

The program, the week, and what students made

1 The case
What students built

2 Why it worked
The design

3 Build one, live
With the room

4 Take it back
What it takes

THE CASE · ISB AI FOUNDERS PROGRAM, AUGUST 5–9, 2026

An AI builder week for grades 7 to 12: *learn AI skills, start a company, build something real.*



Mentors in the room every day



Every team demos what works

7–12 grades, selected by application

5 days, at ISB in August

0 coding experience required

Students don't study startups. *They run one, in ten stages.*

01
Find the idea
A real problem, in one sentence

02
Validate it
Interview real people first

03
Form the team
Builder, designer, storyteller

04
Define the product
The smallest useful version

05
Design it
Screens, type, and color

06
Build it
Direct AI tools to build it

07
Ship it live
A public link of its own

08
Test and iterate
Watch users, then rebuild

09
Brand it
A name, a logo, and a story

10
Pitch and sell
Set a price, pitch it live

Five days, from a one-page plan *to a live product on demo day.*

MORNINGS ARE LESSONS · AFTERNOONS ARE BUILD SESSIONS

DAY 1

Pick a problem

A one-page plan and a first prototype.

DAY 2

Go public

Real people try it. Teams fix what confuses them.

DAY 3

The rebuild

Strong projects rarely look like the day-one plan.

DAY 4

Polish and price

A name, a landing page, and a real price.

DAY 5

Demo day

Two-minute live pitches to judges and families.

THE CASE · WHAT EVERY STUDENT WALKED OUT WITH

Students left with real work, *and they own all of it.*



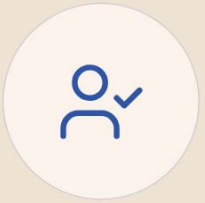
A live product

at its own link, with the code behind it



A live pitch

to judges, families, and peers



Full ownership

of the code, the design, and the brand

THE CASE · DEMO DAY

On day five, teams pitched working products *to judges from Harvard, Stanford, Y Combinator, and AI labs.*



Judges test each product before scoring

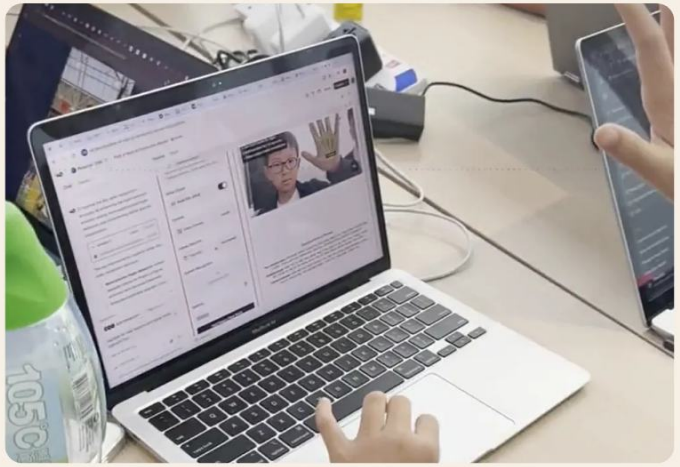


Every team pitched its own product

JUDGED BY FOUNDERS AND OPERATORS FROM HARVARD Stanford Y Combinator *and AI labs*

THE PILOT · BODLEY ACADEMY, HONG KONG, SUMMER 2025

In five days, an 11-year-old *turned sign language into speech.*



Built in five days by a seventh grader

01 **Agency** FIND A PROBLEM	He chose sign language to speech because his cousin is deaf. Nobody assigned it.
02 **Taste** REAL-USER FEEDBACK	He kept improving it after the demo, because his grandmother couldn't use the first version yet.
03 **Craft** FINISH AND LAUNCH	The hardest part wasn't the AI. It was audio clear enough for her to trust.

AI tools did the building. *He did the choosing, judging, and finishing.*

20 students, each on their own problem

5 days, from the first idea to demo day

9.5/10 how likely students were to recommend it

PART 2

It worked because students made every decision, *and AI helped them build faster.*

Used well, AI deepens the thinking instead of replacing it.

THE RESEARCH · TWO 2025 STUDIES

Used as a shortcut, AI does the thinking.
Set up as a coach, it helps students learn more.

−17%

HIGH SCHOOL MATH · NEARLY 1,000 STUDENTS

exam grades after practicing with plain ChatGPT. A tutor version that gave hints, not answers, largely avoided the drop.

2×

HARVARD PHYSICS · A RANDOMIZED TRIAL

the learning gains of an active-learning class, in less time, with an AI tutor built on the same methods

Bastani and others, PNAS, June 25, 2025: grades fell 17% once plain ChatGPT was taken away; with safeguards, the harm was “largely mitigated”; Kestin and others, Scientific Reports, June 3, 2025: 194 Harvard physics students, median learning gains more than double

NAME THE SCARCE SKILLS

Agency chooses, taste judges, *and craft finishes.*

THE THREE SKILLS

01

Agency

Decide what is worth building before anyone assigns it.

02

Taste

Judge whether the output is actually good.

03

Craft

Finish it so people can trust it.

HOW THE WEEK WAS DESIGNED

Each skill had a moment in the week *that students couldn't skip.*

SKILL · HOW THE WEEK TRAINS IT

01

Agency

Students pitch their own idea in three minutes, with no slides, and choose the problem on day one.

02

Taste

A prototype is online by midweek, so real users and mentors react to it every day.

03

Craft

Building stops at a fixed hour, and students explain every decision live on demo day.

IS USING AI JUST CHEATING?

No. AI tools write the code, *and students make every decision.*

AI TOOLS AND MENTORS HANDLE

Writing the code

Putting it online

Fixing technical errors

STUDENTS DECIDE

What to build, and for whom

Which version is better, and why

When it's good enough to ship

WHAT STUDENTS NEED FROM US

Skills grow from practice with structure, *so your role becomes the coach.*



A real project

with something at stake



A coach

who asks how you checked it



Honest feedback

from real people

TRY THIS ON MONDAY · THREE COACHING QUESTIONS

Three questions turn any AI task into practice *in agency, taste, and craft.*



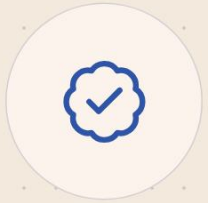
“Why this problem?”

Agency: they choose, not the AI



“How do you know it’s good?”

Taste: they judge what it made



“What would make someone trust it?”

Craft: they check and finish it

PART 3

Now we build one together. *No coding needed.*

You choose the class. We build a practice game for it, live.

LIVE BUILD · 30 MINUTES

You pick a class and a topic.
We build a practice game for it, live.

STEP 1 · YOU DESCRIBE IT

In plain English

Call out the class, the topic, and what the game should do.

→

STEP 2 · WE DIRECT THE AI

A first version in minutes

We give your words to an AI tool that writes the code.

→

STEP 3 · WE ALL CHECK IT

Is it right? Is it good?

Wrong answers, unclear wording, and tiny buttons get fixed.

> *The same loop your students would run: choose, judge, and finish.*

LIVE BUILD · OPEN IT ON YOUR PHONE

It's live. *Open it on your phone.*

PLAY THE GAME

arenaschool.org/talks/2026-10-acamis-tech-workshop/build

WHAT IT TOOK

One room, 30 minutes, and plain English.

No code typed by hand. Every choice was yours: the topic, the questions, and what counted as good enough.

PART 4

Take it back to your school: *what it takes to run this.*

TAKE IT BACK · PLANNING CHECKLIST

Your school already owns most of this. *A practitioner covers the rest.*

YOUR SCHOOL OWNS

- The learning goals and lasting skills
- A five-day block on the calendar
- Teachers, IT, and families on board
- How students show their work

WHERE A PRACTITIONER HELPS

- Matching AI tools to each task
- Prompting that builds thinking
- Working around blocked tools
- Taking an idea to a product in days

The full checklist and a guide to AI tools on school networks in China are on the session page: arenaschool.org/talks/2026-10-acamis-tech-workshop

THIS HOUR WAS THE DEMO

Going further: we help schools bring AI *into teaching and learning.*

AI for Educators

Hands-on training at your school, with your teachers' own lessons

Student programs

A five-day build week like ISB's, run with your teachers

Curriculum design

Where AI fits in your courses, and how to assess it

SELECTED WORK

INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校

Bodley Academy, Hong Kong

SCHWARZMAN SCHOLARS

IF YOU REMEMBER ONE THING

AI doesn’t have to do the thinking for students.

The design is up to us.

1

Students can ship

Real products in five days, with no coding.

2

Design decides

Students choose, judge, and finish.

3

Start small, start now

One project, one class, and three questions.

You don’t need to code. You already know how to coach.

Thank you! *We welcome your questions.*

SLIDES AND RESOURCES

arenaschool.org/talks/2026-10-acamis-tech-workshop

BRING THIS TO YOUR SCHOOL

jingjing@arenaschool.org

Book a 20-minute call about teacher training, student programs, or curriculum design.